

Water Integrity™

Minimal Self-Declaration Framework

Framework Type: Implementation Framework

Related Standard: Water Integrity™ Standard

Version: 1.0

Purpose

This framework provides a **minimal implementation model** enabling producers to apply the Water Integrity™ Standard through transparent self-declaration.

The framework establishes a simple disclosure structure allowing water use in production to be publicly documented.

It does not replace regulatory obligations or certification systems.

Implementation Principle

The minimal level of Water Integrity™ implementation operates through **producer self-declaration**.

Responsibility for accuracy and transparency remains with the declaring entity.

The objective is to create **visible water source and usage transparency** within production systems.

Minimal Implementation Model

Water Integrity™ can be implemented through three core steps:

1. Identify the water source
2. Declare intended water use
3. Declare water status and responsibility

Completion of these steps establishes the minimal transparency baseline.

Step 1 — Identify the Water Source

The producer identifies and documents the water source category used in production.

Possible categories include:

- municipal water supply
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- private well
- surface water (river or lake)
- rainwater collection
- mixed sources

If multiple sources are used, each source must be declared.

Step 2 — Declare Intended Water Use

The producer defines how water interacts with the production process.

Typical usage categories include:

- irrigation
- washing produce
- ingredient inclusion
- processing use
- cleaning or sanitation

The declared use should reflect the actual role of water in production.

Step 3 — Declare Water Status

The producer declares the known status of the water used in production.

Examples of declared status include:

- municipal regulated potable water
- laboratory tested water (test date declared)
- private source with declared status
- non-potable operational water

This framework does not impose laboratory testing requirements.

It requires **transparent declaration of the known status**.

Step 4 — Responsibility Declaration

The producer publishes a short public statement acknowledging responsibility for the declared information.

Example declaration:

"This production declares water use under the Water Integrity™ Standard. Water source, intended use, and declared status are transparently disclosed under producer responsibility."

The declaration may be published:

- on a website
 - in product documentation
 - on supplier transparency sheets
 - through QR code reference
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Documentation Requirements

Minimal implementation requires:

- one water disclosure sheet
- one responsibility declaration
- public accessibility of the information

No external certification or audit is required at the minimal implementation level.

Structural Benefit

The framework transforms:

**undocumented water inputs into
declared water transparency.**

This strengthens:

- supply chain clarity
 - customer trust
 - inspection preparedness
 - production accountability
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Implementation Characteristics

The Water Integrity™ Minimal Self-Declaration Framework is:

- simple to apply
- tool-independent
- scalable
- suitable for small producers
- compatible with larger production systems

It can be implemented immediately without infrastructure change.

Closing Principle

Transparent disclosure of water source and use establishes the minimal structural baseline for credible water-dependent production.

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Canonical Source

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